



Colorado State Committee Meeting – January 6, 2026

Regular Session Minutes

Meeting Place: Via TEAMS

Members Present: Jerry Sonnenberg, Acting State Committee

Staff Present: Jerry Sonnenberg, State Executive Director
Cindy Vukasin, Farm Program Chief
Corey Pelton, Farm Program Chief
Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist
Doug Andresen, Farm Program Specialist
Julie Sporhase, Farm Program Specialist
Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist
Woody Woods, District Director
Scott Brase, District Director
Sam Montoya, District Director
Jon Weishaar, District Director

Guests: None

1. Call to Order

The Colorado State Committee (STC) met on January 6, 2026, Via TEAMS, Jerry Sonnenberg, Acting State Committee opened the Regular Session at 2:30 p.m.

2. Approve Regular Session Minutes

- A The Acting STC reviewed the Regular Session minutes from the December 4, 2025, meeting. After reviewing the minutes, Jerry Sonnenberg, Acting STC approved the minutes.

3. Monthly Leadership Reports (Exhibit 1)

A State Executive Director Report

Jerry Sonnenberg, State Executive Director, gave STO staff a written report of items, events, and pertinent information since the last STC meeting.

B District Director Reports

District Directors, Scott Brase (District 1), Jon Weishaar (District 2), Woody Woods (District 3) and Sam Montoya (District 4) gave the STC written reports regarding their specific districts and included information pertaining to programs, staffing updates, weather conditions, and other pertinent information since the last STC meeting.

C Acting Farm Loan Chief Report

Kim Lacy, Acting Farm Loan Program Chief, provided the STC with a written report of items, events, and pertinent information regarding farm loan and staff since the last STC meeting.

D Farm Program Chief Reports

Cindy Vukasin, Farm Program Chief and Corey Pelton, Farm Program Chief, gave the STC written reports of items, events, and pertinent information regarding farm programs and staff since the last STC meeting.

4. Noninsured Crop Disaster Assistance Program (NAP)

A CPLGW authorization - correction

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented to the STC with information in Exhibit 2. It was discovered that the tables previously presented to Acting STC had rounding errors that were created by the software. Acting STC to review corrected tables and determine if the use of collective percent of loss grazing worksheet (CPLGW) can be used as an alternative collective loss percentage method for determining percentage losses for grazing for 2025 and future years.

Colorado has not historically set a collective loss (by County) for small grains or sorghum forage. Based on data available and TSP providers available the recommendation is to set the full season grass as recommended by NRCS and fall/winter small grain growth curve as recommended by CSU Extension and not set a spring/full season small grain or sorghum forage growth curve. This should not be a detriment to the producer as Colorado has not historically set a collective loss (by County) for small grains or sorghum forage.

Below are the corrected tables to be reviewed and acted on.

Fall/Winter – Small Grain

Use CSU Extension recommendation

COUNTY	GC Jan	GC Feb	GC Mar	GC Apr	GC May	GC Jun	GC Jul	GC Aug	GC Sep	GC Oct	GC Nov	GC Dec
All	-	-	0.04	0.15	0.29	0.19	0.03	0.02	0.09	0.13	0.06	0.04

Grass - Full Season / Improved Grass

Use NRCS data for the grass growth curve, except for the counties with missing or incomplete data: Clear Creek, Eagle, Gilpin, Lake, Pitkin, San Juan and Summit. For those counties the recommendation is to use a similar counties growth curve:

Clear Creek – use Park

COUNTY	GC Jan	GC Feb	GC Mar	GC Apr	GC May	GC Jun	GC Jul	GC Aug	GC Sep	GC Oct	GC Nov	GC Dec
PARK	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.03	0.15	0.10	0.37	0.30	0.05	0.00	0.00	0.00

Eagle – use Routt (Pitkin/Summit also missing data)

COUNTY	GC Jan	GC Feb	GC Mar	GC Apr	GC May	GC Jun	GC Jul	GC Aug	GC Sep	GC Oct	GC Nov	GC Dec
ROUTT	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.09	0.29	0.37	0.14	0.05	0.06	0.00	0.00	0.00

Gilpin – use Boulder

COUNTY	GC Jan	GC Feb	GC Mar	GC Apr	GC May	GC Jun	GC Jul	GC Aug	GC Sep	GC Oct	GC Nov	GC Dec
BOULDER	0.00	0.00	0.02	0.08	0.22	0.31	0.16	0.11	0.07	0.03	0.00	0.00

Lake – use Park

COUNTY	GC Jan	GC Feb	GC Mar	GC Apr	GC May	GC Jun	GC Jul	GC Aug	GC Sep	GC Oct	GC Nov	GC Dec
PARK	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.03	0.15	0.10	0.37	0.30	0.05	0.00	0.00	0.00

Pitkin – use Gunnison (Eagle also missing data)

COUNTY	GC Jan	GC Feb	GC Mar	GC Apr	GC May	GC Jun	GC Jul	GC Aug	GC Sep	GC Oct	GC Nov	GC Dec
GUNNISON	0.00	0.01	0.01	0.04	0.24	0.36	0.22	0.03	0.04	0.04	0.00	0.00

San Juan – use La Plata

COUNTY	GC Jan	GC Feb	GC Mar	GC Apr	GC May	GC Jun	GC Jul	GC Aug	GC Sep	GC Oct	GC Nov	GC Dec
LA PLATA	0.00	0.00	0.07	0.28	0.32	0.21	0.03	0.00	0.04	0.06	0.00	0.00

Summit – use Grand

COUNTY	GC Jan	GC Feb	GC Mar	GC Apr	GC May	GC Jun	GC Jul	GC Aug	GC Sep	GC Oct	GC Nov	GC Dec
GRAND	0.00	0.03	0.04	0.10	0.33	0.37	0.09	0.00	0.05	0.00	0.00	0.00

The following Counties also show zero production in August. This is an anomaly considering it is in the middle of the growing season. With those counties having primarily cool season grasses, no growth was documented. STC may want to make an adjustment based on STC knowledge.

COUNTY	GC Jan	GC Feb	GC Mar	GC Apr	GC May	GC Jun	GC Jul	GC Aug	GC Sep	GC Oct	GC Nov	GC Dec
ARCHULETA	0.00	0.00	0.01	0.10	0.30	0.34	0.14	0.00	0.05	0.05	0.00	0.00
DELTA	0.00	0.02	0.18	0.30	0.27	0.13	0.00	0.00	0.04	0.06	0.00	0.00
DOLORES	0.00	0.01	0.07	0.26	0.31	0.22	0.03	0.00	0.04	0.06	0.00	0.00
GRAND	0.00	0.03	0.04	0.10	0.33	0.37	0.09	0.00	0.05	0.00	0.00	0.00
JACKSON	0.00	0.02	0.03	0.10	0.33	0.38	0.09	0.00	0.05	0.00	0.00	0.00
LA PLATA	0.00	0.00	0.07	0.28	0.32	0.21	0.03	0.00	0.04	0.06	0.00	0.00
MINERAL	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.05	0.30	0.38	0.17	0.00	0.05	0.05	0.00	0.00
MONTEZUMA	0.02	0.03	0.09	0.25	0.29	0.19	0.03	0.00	0.04	0.05	0.00	0.00
MONTROSE	0.03	0.04	0.10	0.26	0.28	0.18	0.02	0.00	0.04	0.05	0.00	0.00
OURAY	0.00	0.00	0.08	0.31	0.32	0.18	0.00	0.00	0.04	0.06	0.00	0.00
SAN MIGUEL	0.02	0.02	0.10	0.29	0.30	0.18	0.00	0.00	0.04	0.05	0.00	0.00

COUNTY	GC Jan	GC Feb	GC Mar	GC Apr	GC May	GC Jun	GC Jul	GC Aug	GC Sep	GC Oct	GC Nov	GC Dec
SUMMIT	0.05	0.30	0.40	0.10	0.07	0.06	0.02	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 2), the Acting STC approved the corrected tables as presented and shown above, the Acting STC approved the STO recommendation for Grass-Full Season / Improved Grass.

5. Risk Management (RMA)

A Consultation 202508R0141 T Yield Change

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with information in Exhibit 3 for STC concurrence on RMAs T-yield changes for barley, corn, grain sorghum, hemp, millet, popcorn, silage sorghum, sunflowers and triticale for the 2026 crop year. RMA Consultation 202508R0141.

There was a concern with Washington Grain Sorghum – Huge drop for an irrigated yield 54 bu/ac to 14 bu/ac. Additional information was requested from RMA.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation in Exhibit 3, the Acting State Committee concurred with RMAs expansion of RMA coverage - Triticale for Grain (Gr) for 2026 and subsequent crop years by expanding coverage to Alamosa, Conejos, Costilla, Elbert, Kiowa, Logan, Moffat and Rio Grande. Acting STC designates Janae Rader authority to submit the determination electronically.

B Consultation 202508R0145 Final Plant Date Sorghum

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with information in Exhibit 4 for STC concurrence on RMAs final plant date changes on grain sorghum for grain for crop year 2026 listed in Exhibit 4. RMA Consultation 202508R0145.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 4), the Acting State Committee concurred final plant date changes on grain sorghum for grain for crop year 2026. Acting STC designates Janae Rader authority to submit the determination electronically.

6. Adjournment

There being no further business, the Regular Session was adjourned at 2:45 p.m. The next meeting is scheduled for February 10, 2026 via TEAMs.

Approved:

State Committee Chairperson

Date

State Executive Director

Date

Colorado State Committee Meeting

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